

7 Mental Talk :

One who knows math can solve many problems.

8 Let's think :

Our brain is powerful. We should make good use of it.

Tail-piece

Wise men solve others' problems. But who will help them when they are in a fix (in trouble) ? Here follows a story for you to read and get the answer.

SIX WISE MEN

Once six wise men went on a journey together. On their way, there was a deep river. There was no boat. So they swam across the river. They all reached the other bank safely.

"Are we all safe?" asked one of the wise men.

"Let's make sure," said the others.

The first man counted the others, "One, two, three, four, five" and said, "Look! One of us is missing. There are only five of us here!"

"You're silly," said the second wise man. "Let me count and see. One, two, three, four, five. Yes, we're only five. God! One of us is missing".

The third man counted, and then the fourth man. Yes, there are only five of them!

They all sat down and cried, "One of us is drowned. How sad! Our dear friend is drowned. What shall we do now?"

After some time, the leader of the wise men said, "We started our journey on a bad day. So we lost one of us. We will not go on now. Let's go back home". The others agreed.

The wise men swam across the river and reached the other bank. A poor illiterate man from their village saw them. He asked, "Aren't you going on your journey?"

"No, we're not," said the leader of the wise men. "We lost one of our friends in the river. So we're going back home".

"Who did you lose?"

"We don't know. We were six. Now we're only five".



The illiterate villager counted them. They were six, and not five. He thought, "These men are really foolish. Each of them counted only the others. So he counted five. Now I'll teach them how to count".

He then told them, "Stand in a line. I'll count".

The villager went to the first man , gave a rap on his head , and counted, "One". He gave a rap on the second man's head and counted, "Two". In this way he went on. He gave a rap on the sixth man's head and counted, "Six".

"Now you see, you're six, and not five".

"Hey, you're right! We're six now!" one of the wise men said.

The leader of the wise men said, "It is good that the missing man has come back. Now let's go on our journey".

WORD NOTE

- quarrel (v) : to have an angry argument, କଳି କରିବା
- sand-hill : hill of sand by the sea or in the desert,
ବାଲିହୁଙ୍କା ବାଲିର ପାହାଡ଼
- shepherd : a person who looks after sheep, ମେଷପାଳକ

Tail-piece

- agree (v) : have the same opinion as someone has,
ରାଜିହେବା
- drown (v) : to die in water because you cannot
breathe, ପାଣିରେ ବୁଡ଼ିଯିବା
- illiterate (opposite- literate) : not able to read or write, ମୂର୍ଖ, ନିରକ୍ଷର
- missing : lost, ହଜିଯାଇଥିବା
- rap (v) : to hit something quickly and lightly,
ଧୀରେ ଆଘାତ କରିବା
- silly (opposite: sensible, wise) : foolish, ବୋକା